

Lester Cheong

Full-Stack Engineer

Singapore · SG · lestercheong70@outlook.com · <https://cheonglol.github.io/cheonglol>

Summary

Full-stack generalist. Left corporate banking to build software for small businesses — where what you ship actually reaches users and they talk to you directly. TypeScript-dominant. Runs everything on Railway with Fastify + PostgreSQL. Lays groundwork for sustainable additions so changes stay cheap.

Experience

Freelance Software Engineer

Self-employed | Dec 2024 – Present

- 3 paying clients. Delivered a Telegram-based order management system (24-26 daily users, PostgreSQL, role-based access, CRON reports)
- Built an AI photobooth for live events using Replicate AI
- Built a restaurant PWA with digital menu, seasonal banners, and offline-first service worker
- Sole operator on all systems: CI/CD, monitoring, on-call, infrastructure
- All production backends deployed on Railway (Fastify, PostgreSQL, zero-downtime deploys)

API Developer, Digital Channels & OpenBanking

OCBC Bank | Apr 2023 – Sep 2024

- OpenBanking API development. Owned partner onboarding pipeline: spec review, implementation, regression testing, production release
- Managed change tickets through banking-grade release gates
- Zero rollback incidents
- Mentored IGNITE apprentices on an internal portal (React, Spring)

IGNITE Apprenticeship, OpenBanking & Partnerships

OCBC Bank | Mar 2022 – Mar 2023

- Built a Node.js CLI that parses Postman collections, auto-generates assertion tests, and renders results on a dashboard
- Replaced manual QA for the team's API regression suite
- Won Rookie of the Year
- Taught JavaScript to secondary school students via Code@OCBC

IoT Lock Technician

SG Bike | Nov 2018 – Aug 2020

- Shared-mobility startup. Trained 3 interns
- Wrote the team's first troubleshooting documentation
- Reverse-engineered a competitor's lock firmware acquired through M&A (no keys provided) to integrate into fleet operations

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, SvelteKit, Python

Backend & Infrastructure: Fastify, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Redis, Railway, Docker, Bun, CI/CD, Cloudflare, Linux

Integrations & APIs: Stripe, Xero API, Azure AD, grammY, Temporal.io, oRPC, Zod

AI & Emerging: LangChain, LangGraph, Mastra AI, Replicate AI, MCP Servers, DeepSeek, RAG Applications

Projects

Sales Consolidator: Order Pipeline

Replaced manual spreadsheet workflow with a structured order pipeline. Salespersons submit orders via Telegram. PostgreSQL source of truth. Role-based admin flows, CRON-triggered daily summaries.

- Zero data loss since launch
- AI product catalog intake: upload transcripts, DeepSeek AI structures them into product rows

Valentino Houseparty: AI Avatar & Interactive Arcade

4-station beauty brand event activation. AI pixel art avatar (Replicate flux-kontext-pro), Snake game, video stations, prize claim system. Built as SvelteKit 5 SPA with Fastify 5 API.

- Deployed at live event. Client was happy, event ran live
- Retro Windows 98 UI with 98.css

Themelios: AI Accounts Receivables Platform

AI-powered platform for invoice management, collections, and payment reconciliation. Temporal.io for durable workflow orchestration, Mastra AI agents, Xero/Stripe integrations.

- Over-engineered for the problem and never shipped. A lesson in scoping